HOORVIA — PORK INTERNAL TEMPERATURE CHART (LEAN CUTS VS BBQ COLLAGEN CUTS)

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet • 145°F USDA Lean Standard vs 195°F–203°F Pulled Pork & Ribs • US Letter (8.5" × 11")

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■ LEAN WHOLE-MUSCLE PORK CUTS (TARGET 145°F / 63°C + 3-MIN REST)

Lean Pork Cut	Pull From Heat At	Final Rested Temp	Rest Time	Visual Cue & Juiciness Note
Boneless Pork Loin Chops (1" thick)	140°F–142°F / 60°C	145°F / 63°C (USDA)	3–4 min	Faint blush pink center; firm yet juicy
Bone-In Rib / Center-Cut Chops	141°F–143°F / 61°C	145°F–147°F / 63°C	4–5 min	Bone insulates meat; probe away from bone
Whole Pork Tenderloin (1–1.25 lb)	140°F / 60°C	145°F / 63°C	5 min	Very lean muscle; dries rapidly past 150°F
Boneless Pork Top Loin Roast (2–4 lb)	138°F–140°F / 59°C	145°F / 63°C	10–12 min	Large roast has 5°F–7°F carryover climb
Bone-In Crown Roast of Pork	138°F / 59°C	145°F / 63°C	15 min	Shield rib tips with foil to prevent charring
Thick-Cut Pork Steak (Sirloin)	145°F–150°F / 63°C	150°F–155°F / 66°C	5 min	Slightly more marbling than center loin

■ SLOW-COOKED BBQ & COLLAGEN PORK CUTS (195°F – 205°F RENDERING ZONE)

BBQ /Tough Pork Cut	USDA Safe Temp	Chef Target Temp	Rest Time	Why High Internal Temp Is Required
Pork Butt / Boston Shoulder (Pulled)	145°F (Tough!)	200°F–203°F / 93°C–95°C	45–60 min (Insulated)	Collagen melts at 195°F+; bone wiggles free
Picnic Pork Shoulder Roast	145°F (Chewy)	198°F–202°F / 92°C–94°C	30–45 min	Shreds effortlessly with two forks at 200°F
Baby Back Ribs (Loin Back)	145°F	190°F–195°F / 88°C–90°C	10 min	Clean bite-through without meat falling off
St. Louis / Spare Ribs (Belly Side)	145°F	198°F–203°F / 92°C–95°C	10–15 min	Heavier fat & cartilage require 200°F render
Pork Belly Slab (Burnt Ends / Roast)	145°F	195°F–200°F / 90°C–93°C	10 min	Turns thick layers of white fat buttery soft
Pork Hock / Osso Buco Shanks	145°F	195°F–200°F / 90°C–93°C	10 min	Braise in liquid until fork-tender

■ GROUND PORK, SAUSAGES & CURED HAM TEMPERATURES

Ground or Cured Pork Item	Pull From Heat At	Final Target Temp	Cooking & Food Safety Rule
Ground Pork Burgers / Patties	157°F / 69°C	160°F / 71°C (Strict)	Grinding mixes surface bacteria throughout meat
Fresh Raw Italian / Bratwurst Links	157°F / 69°C	160°F / 71°C	Poach or sear gently at 350°F so casings don't burst
Pork Dumpling / Meatball Filling	160°F / 71°C	160°F+ / 71°C+	Probe center of largest meatball
Pre-Cooked Spiral / City Ham	135°F / 57°C	140°F / 60°C	Already pasteurized; heat wrapped in foil to stay moist
Fresh Uncured 'Green' Ham (Raw)	140°F / 60°C	145°F / 63°C	Rest 15 minutes before carving

CHEF'S PRO TIP: When smoking or roasting a pork shoulder for pulled pork, expect 'The Stall' around 155°F–165°F, where evaporative cooling stops the internal temperature from rising for hours. Wrap tightly in pink butcher paper or heavy foil ('Texas Crutch') at 165°F to power through to 203°F!
USDA SAFE MINIMUM INTERNAL TEMPS: All Poultry & Ground Poultry: 165°F (74°C) • Ground Beef/Pork/Lamb: 160°F (71°C) • Whole Pork, Beef & Fish: 145°F (63°C)

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